



The Midas Verona 48 Input Mixing Console at the Front of House to ensure the audience gets the best possible sound

can be controlled over a standard Ethernet connection, so we can adjust the output from anywhere in the hall", he says. They spoke of it with cool nonchalance, boredom even, while we were replacing our eyes in their sockets and wiping the drool that had begun to show.

So while the band played their instruments (first one at a time and then all together), Sunil did the rounds of the hall, using SmaartLive to measure the sound output at different locations and then using his Tablet PC to remotely change settings in Audio Core.

The band continued to practise for a while, for the benefit of the FOH engineers who kept monitoring the sound so that the audience is kept happy, and for the monitor engineers, who can then learn the artists' preferences.

So is it all about technology? "The human ear does play a very important role in the whole process—even with all the measurements, it has the final say in how the system sounds", Sunil tells us.

On a tangent, watching and listening to a band practise before a concert can be a whole lot better than the concert itself, and is an experience that's highly recommended by this writer.

Showtime!

In a startling show of fortitude, we were still able to watch the technology even while one of our favourite bands was playing on stage. We'd thought that now that the sound had been adjusted over and over again, even the engineers could sit back and enjoy the music. Apparently not.

Even something as seemingly harmless as the audience's entry into the hall can change the sound, so the guys still have to keep monitoring the sound quality and changing settings from time to time.

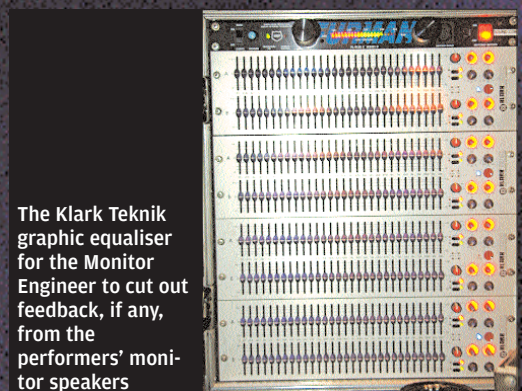
Thanks to the day's efforts, the audience was happy, the band was happy, we were happy, and a good time was had by all. The satisfaction and relief on everyone's face just spoke for itself.

The JBL Line Array speakers. The bigger speakers at the bottom are the subwoofers. Together, the lot blasts sound to nearly the entire hall

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SOUND.COM

Mumbai-based SOUND.COM—the sound engineers and audio equipment supplier for the event—has an impressive clientele that includes names such as Remo Fernandes, Sivamani, Pentagram, Anoushka Shankar, Paul Van Dyk, Jethro Tull (obviously), and many more.



The Klark Teknik graphic equaliser for the Monitor Engineer to cut out feedback, if any, from the performers' monitor speakers

Endnote

Don't tell anyone, but all we *really* wanted was an excuse to spend the day at the concert (free), and still get our daily bread. As it turns out, there's a *lot* more to setting up a concert than just a few good speakers and a ear for sound. As an observer, you need to fortify yourself against scary-sounding terms such as frequency responses, signal conditioning, electro-acoustics, low-pass filters... you get the picture. This writer would probably have fallen asleep with all the electronics jargon if he hadn't paid attention in class those few years ago.

The guys at SOUND.COM probably breakfast on transistors and capacitors (they may not admit this, though) and make light snacks of ICs. The most difficult question we could possibly ask them? "Do you love electronics more, or music?"

We thank SOUND.COM for putting up with our constant harassment, especially Sunil, who was always happy to answer questions even at the busiest times during the show! We would also like to thank Tower of Power and Only Much Louder—the organisers of the show—for permitting us to descend upon the venue. And

finally, Jethro Tull and Alms for Shanti. For the music. ■

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